The Dhāraṇī of the Noble Mārīcī

Āryamārīcīnāmadhāraṇī · Toh 988 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་མ་འདོད་ཟེར་ཅན་ཞེས་བྱ་བའི་གཟུངས།

The Dhāraṇī of the Noble Marīcī, known in Sanskrit as Āryamārīcīnāmadhāraṇī and in Tibetan as 'Phags ma 'od zer can zhes bya ba'i gzungs, is a short scripture centered on Marīcī, a goddess whose name means "Ray of Light." It opens in the familiar style of a sūtra, with the Buddha staying at Jeta's Grove near Śrāvastī, surrounded by a great assembly of monks and bodhisattvas. There he tells the monks of Marīcī, who travels ahead of the sun and the moon and who cannot be seen, seized, bound, harmed, or overcome by enemies. He teaches that those who know her name and recite her dhāraṇī will share in that same invulnerability and protection from danger. The work is Toh 988 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts, the protective incantations often gathered together in the canon's collection of dhāraṇīs.

In the language of India: ārya mārīcī nāma dhāraṇī

In the language of Tibet: The Dhāraṇī of the Noble Marīcī.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in Prince Jeta's Grove, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. With him were a great Saṅgha of twelve hundred and fifty monks and many bodhisattva great beings.

Then the Blessed One said to the monks, "Monks, there is a goddess called Marīcī. She goes ahead of the sun and the moon. She cannot be seen, cannot be seized, cannot be bound, cannot be stopped, and cannot be overcome. She cannot be confused, cannot be punished, cannot be beheaded, cannot be drowned, and cannot be burned. She does not fall into the power of enemies.

"Monks, whoever knows the name of that goddess Marīcī, that person too cannot be seen, cannot be seized, cannot be bound, cannot be stopped, and cannot be overcome. That person cannot be confused, cannot be punished, cannot be beheaded, cannot be drowned, and cannot be burned. That person will not fall into the power of enemies.

"Likewise, since I too know the name of the goddess Marīcī, may I too become unable to be seen. May I become unable to be seized. May I become unable to be bound. May I become unable to be stopped. May I become unable to be

overcome. May I become unable to be confused. May I become unable to be punished. May I become unable to be beheaded. May I become unable to be drowned. May I become unable to be burned. May I not fall into the power of enemies.

"For this, the words of the secret mantra are these:

tadyathā oṃ patākramasi varākramasi udayamasi nairamasi arkkamasi markkamasi urmamasi phanamasi gulmamasi cīvaramasi mahācīvarmasi antaradhaṃnamasi svāhā

oṃ Goddess Marīcī, protect me on the road! Protect me from wrong paths! Protect me from the danger of people! Protect me from the danger of kings! Protect me from the danger of elephants! Protect me from the danger of bandits and thieves! Protect me from the danger of nāgas! Protect me from the danger of lions! Protect me from the danger of tigers! Protect me from the danger of fire! Protect me from the danger of water! Protect me from the danger of snakes! Protect me from the danger of poison and blades! Protect me from opponents and from all enemies! In all circumstances, in turmoil and out of turmoil, in decline and out of decline, guard me from lions! Guard me from tigers! Guard me from nāgas! Guard me from snakes! svāhā

Guard me, guard me from all dangers, harms, contagious diseases, and all turmoil!

namo ratnatrayāya tadyathā oṃ ālo tālo kālo sacchalo sama vamūrdtiṭi rakṣa rakṣa māṃ

Guard me and all sentient beings from all harm, danger, and disease! svāhā

"Homage to the Three Jewels. One should recite the heart mantra of the goddess Marīcī:

tadyathā oṃ battāli padāli barāli pārāhamukhi sarbaduṣṭā praduṣṭānāṃ cakṣurmukhaṃ bandha bandha bandhamukhaṃ jaṃbhaya staṃbhaya mohaya svāhā

oṃ mārīcyi svāhā

oṃ barāli badāli battālī bārātramukhi sarbaduṣṭānāṃ praduṣṭānāṃ cakṣurmukhaṃ bandha bandha svāhā"

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks, those bodhisattvas, that entire assembly, and the world with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This concludes the Dhāraṇī of the Noble Marīcī.

It was translated by the paṇḍita Amoghavajra and the translator, the monk Bari Rinchen Drak.

Translator's Notes

• In the first list of qualities the text reads "thus not," which makes no sense in context. The lists that follow read "cannot be seen" at that point, so that reading has been translated. The term rendered "cannot be drowned" is uncertain; it may instead mean "cannot be melted" or "cannot be crushed."

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.